

Thaddeus Liu

Technical & Programmatic SEO Lead · 15+ Years Scaling Organic Growth Systems

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Summary

15+ years building organic growth systems where templates, structured data, and search-intent mapping replace manual page production. From modular per-word pages at Youdao Dictionary (~200 → 180K–200K/day non-brand organic UV), to **1.5M POI landing pages** at eLong (~9× non-brand organic orders over 4 years, ~20–30M RMB net profit in the best year), to a **global SEO middle platform** at Alibaba (reversed a 3–4-year organic decline with +10–15% YoY total site UV year-1; **99.97% of 5–6B indexed pages were found to not earn their existence**), to **GEO / AEO** customer-acquisition on Doubao / DeepSeek and other AI assistants today — the through-line is the same: programmatic SEO and content engineering, not manual operation. Hands-on with the full technical SEO stack — GSC + log file analysis, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, SEMrush, GA4 + BigQuery — plus self-built crawlers, log parsers, sitemap generators, and schema pipelines. Now extending the same engineering mindset to LLM-powered search.

Core Skills

Technical SEO: Crawl/render/index, log file analysis, Core Web Vitals, JSON-LD structured data, hreflang, canonicalization, redirect strategy, site migrations, sitemap & robots architecture

Programmatic SEO at Scale: Template-driven million-page generation, search-intent → page-archetype mapping, entity-based SEO, topical authority, internal linking architecture

AEO / GEO: Brand visibility & acquisition on Doubao / DeepSeek and other AI assistants; AI-Overview / answer-engine / generative-search optimization

Documentation & Developer Content: Wiki/dictionary-pattern IA, developer-intent content roadmaps, search-driven information architecture

SEO Tooling: Google Search Console, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, SEMrush, GA4, BigQuery, log analysis; self-built crawlers, schema pipelines, sitemap generators, internal-link auditors

Web Fundamentals: HTML/CSS review for SEO issues, HTTP status codes, CDN configuration, DNS, JS-rendered site indexing

Experimentation: Large-scale A/B and multivariate testing, causal evaluation, statistical-significance discipline

Cross-Functional Leadership: Engineering × content × data science × product marketing; influencing platform and infrastructure decisions

Experience

AI Product Director, Guazi used-cars

May 2026 – present

Built 3 in-house AI product systems from scratch in 2 months: AI Creative (image/video generation), AI Placement (bid/budget optimization), and AI KOL Discovery (3-channel sourcing incl. a human-as-AI-tool approach). GEO for buyer and seller acquisition on a C2C marketplace, with content + query research outsourced and strategy + feedback loop in-house. Building in-house GEO.

- **3 in-house AI product systems (built from scratch in 2 months):** AI Creative produces image/video ad creatives — designed to reach human-medium quality and **raise the overall creative baseline by racing with external agencies**, forcing them to dig for better creative directions. AI Placement controls bid and budget allocation. AI KOL Discovery runs 3 parallel channels — Douyin's official KOL marketplace, internal CRM, and a **human-as-AI-tool approach using 1→10→80 phones** that leverages Douyin's recommendation algorithm to surface KOLs not listed in the official marketplace. **Current state: 1 phone in production, 10 in trial, scaling to 80.**
- **GEO / AEO:** Outsourced content production and query research; in-house ownership of strategy and the feedback loop. Targeting **Doubao / DeepSeek and other Chinese AI assistants for buyer AND seller acquisition on a C2C used-car marketplace. One of the few production GEO programs in China.** Building in-house GEO.
- **Growth-product infrastructure** (built from scratch, redefining the minimal viable unit after inheriting a sprawling previous path): landing pages, attribution, postback — the technical foundation behind all organic and paid acquisition.

Owned organic + paid acquisition, a production GEO operation, and lead-gen automation across domestic and international B2B business. Led a team of 4.

- **Designed and ran a production GEO operation** on **Doubao / DeepSeek** and other Chinese AI assistants across three China-market B2B lines — end-to-end loop from query discovery through ranking-factor analysis to content and monitoring. **GEO-attributed pipeline opportunities for the service-robot line grew from ~10% to ~50%** (monthly avg), with a 63% peak during Doubao's Spring Festival ad campaign. Attribution closed through a standardized CS-led source-verification script.
- **Led paid acquisition** (search + feed) across Baidu / Douyin / WeChat with AI-assisted creative and industry-differentiated landing pages, delivering **3.6x MQL** against a +100% target. Reduced MQL cost 15–40% via a sales-signal feedback loop.
- Mapped competitor distributor networks across countries via LinkedIn outreach, generating **+100% non-paid SQL** for the overseas robot expansion.

Head of Growth — Subscription Content (International Markets), TouchShort Media July 2024 – Jan 2025 (Chongqing)

Full-funnel growth for an overseas short-drama app; built 0 → scalable user-acquisition system.

- Scaled paid spend 0 → **\$10K/day** with framework proven scalable to **\$100K/day** achieved first-day **ROI 0.6–1.0+** at \$10K/day (industry benchmark ~0.4).
- User-profile-driven landing pages combined with AI-assisted content production and multi-variant testing lifted **ROI by 30%**.
- Multilingual localization content pipeline — dramatically improved content supply efficiency across markets.

User Growth Leader (SEA), Lazada (Alibaba Group)

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

User growth, organic content distribution, and ad operations across Southeast Asia — multi-country, multi-language, multi-culture.

- **Re-architected content and SKU distribution around user location** — kickstart work redefining user profiles, scenarios, USPs, and creative logic delivered **+40% buyers** location-based distribution lifted **conversion rate +50%** (benchmark 5%); profile-based distribution added **+8–13% CR** in Fashion and Beauty.
- Extracted **~100 reusable scenarios** from Lazada's 3,600 leaf categories — a **user-profile → scenario → top-selling-SKU** intent framework for multi-country, multi-locale content production at scale.
- AI-generated selling-point and scenario creatives nearly replaced manual creative (90% of spend). In Indonesia, started a new paid-acquisition set under the same account — as efficiency beat the original user-growth team's approach, **budget grew from <5% to ~70% of total Indonesia paid spend** (cumulative ~\$1M USD over ~30 days), delivering **+20% buyer count** vs. the 2% team benchmark. All incremental value.

Senior Traffic Growth Expert — SEO Middle Platform, Alibaba (China)

Aug 2017 – Sept 2019

Built a **global e-commerce SEO middle platform** supporting AliExpress, Alibaba.com, Taobao Overseas, and other global businesses for organic growth — hreflang, canonicalization, internal-linking, and schema at multi-country scale.

- **The diagnosis most teams miss.** AliExpress / Alibaba.com had ~5–6B indexed pages each; only **~0.03–0.04% (~2M)** earned their existence — the rest were diluting crawl budget and drowning out good content. Previous long-tail SEO work had *added* pages, making it worse.
- **Phase 1 — content convergence.** Removed ~10–20M duplicate landing pages on AliExpress. **Long-tail non-brand organic traffic went up ~70K UV/day in ~10 days** with no new content. Sometimes the answer to "more traffic" is "fewer pages."
- **Phase 2 — the SEO middle platform.** Built shared infrastructure (hreflang, canonicalization, schema, sitemaps, internal linking) at platform scale, plus a keyword-clustering pipeline for ~600M keywords across ~10–15 languages. **DAMO Academy quoted 20 engineers × 1 year per language** to do the clustering; Thaddeus's team did it with **1 engineer × 1 month** (~50% coverage completed). Stop building parallel per-market systems; build one platform that does it right.
- **Results.** Reversed a 3–4-year organic-traffic decline with **+10–15% YoY total site UV in year 1** orders (AliExpress) and quote requests (Alibaba.com) growing in parallel. Taobao Overseas long-tail added ~150K UV/day. **Saved 90%+ headcount vs. DAMO Academy's quoted cost** (conservative; the real saving is 99%+). Full-funnel UX optimization lifted organic CR by 10%.

Online Marketing Director — SEO / SEM, eLong (under Expedia; acquired by Ctrip / Aug 2012 – Aug 2017 Trip.com in 2017)

Owned scalable organic and paid acquisition for one of China's largest OTAs — non-brand programmatic SEO plus SEM automation at platform scale.

- **Programmatic SEO at scale**: built a **1.5M-POI landing-page system** from Gaode / Baidu map data + eLong's hotel inventory. One templated page form covering every POI type; each page answered the traveler decision journey — how to get there, local services within 5km, ≥3 bookable hotels nearby. **~9× growth in non-brand organic orders over 4 years**, contributing **20–30M RMB annual net profit in the best year**.
- **Quality gate, not vibes**: ship-or-not for a POI was the **≥3-bookable-hotels-within-5km rule** — a real business-value condition, not a search-volume threshold. Of 15–20M raw map POIs, the system shipped 1.5M, with ~90% indexed. Also killed a 150K-UV/day intracity transit-routes feature that had zero business value.
- **SEM automation platform**: replaced a 15-person manual operation with a Ruby on Rails platform and a unified search-engine API abstraction. Steady-state **20M keywords** across Baidu / 360 / Sogou / Shenma. **ROI +50%** vs. the manual baseline; team evolved from 1 SEO operator + 5 editors to 5 engineers, 0 SEO operators, 0 editors.

SEO Engineer — Dictionary, Translation, News, Auto, NetEase Youdao

Feb 2011 – Aug 2012

Organic-traffic growth across Youdao Dictionary, Youdao Translation, NetEase News, and NetEase Auto.

- **Templated long-tail SEO for Youdao Dictionary**: per-word pages (foreign ↔ Chinese) at dict.youdao.com, each content module at its own URL so the right module ranks for the right query. Term corpus from an upstream user-input source (Sogou input-method vocabulary) — capturing real search intent before it reaches search engines. **Non-brand organic UV ~200/day → 180–200K/day**. Same modular-page pattern today's developer-documentation SEO uses. This was before 'programmatic SEO' was a recognized term.

Data Engineer (Solo Builder), Global Procurement Database Startup (Overseas)

Sept 2019 – Mar 2022

- Independently built a B2B global procurement decision-maker database for US/EU markets and a proprietary user-mapping algorithm with substantial overlap against the leading competitor.
- Generated SQL-level contacts that enabled outbound sales attempts; ran a small data-export business.

Software Engineer → Development Lead, Sina Real Estate (Leju) — Sina-affiliated real-estate vertical Jan 2008 – Jan 2011

- Grew from software engineer to development lead (4 engineers). Self-taught SEO and trained the operations team. **The origin of platform/framework thinking**: abstracted the sales team's repetitive work across different properties into a replicable framework — the insight that later powered the SEO middle platform at Alibaba.

Technical Support Engineer, PeopleCert (Greece)

Jan 2007 – Jan 2008

- Software testing and debugging; on-site technical support for enterprise clients across Europe.

Education

Beijing Jiaotong University, BSc in Information and Computing Science

2002 – 2006